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WORLD BANK | ECONOMIC REFORM

World Bank Sets Conditions for Tripling Pakistan's Incomes

A new development update links the prospect of sharply higher living standards by 2050 to sustained changes in productivity, exports and institutions.

On Thursday, 22 October, the World Bank presented a long-term reform scenario under which Pakistan could triple income per person by 2050. The analysis did not promise that result under existing policies. It tied the outcome to faster structural changes capable of lifting economic growth into a roughly 6.2–6.9 per cent range. The central distinction is between a conditional pathway and a short-term forecast.

The update reported economic growth of 3.7 per cent in fiscal year 2025–26, compared with 3.2 per cent a year earlier. It also noted a primary fiscal surplus equivalent to 2.9 per cent of GDP in FY26. Yet growth in output per person remained about 1.6 per cent. Those figures show why stronger headline growth need not rapidly transform household incomes when population growth and low productivity absorb much of the increase.

BACKGROUND / ANALYSIS

Pakistan has faced repeated stabilisation programmes and external financing pressure. The World Bank model sets out a long-term pathway, not a short-term forecast. Macroeconomic stability must be joined to reforms in taxation, energy, trade and education. Export competitiveness, investment and productivity determine whether gains endure.

THREE REVISION POINTS

— The World Bank's threefold per-capita income possibility refers to 2050 and requires faster reform.

— FY26 real GDP growth was reported at 3.7%, up from 3.2% in FY25.

— The FY26 primary fiscal surplus was reported at 2.9% of GDP.

CSS ANGLE Current Affairs / Pakistan Affairs: growth, productivity and structural adjustment.

REPORTING [01] · [02]

AT A GLANCE

MACROECONOMY World Bank outlines a conditional pathway to triple income per person by 2050.

GLOBAL ECONOMY IMF forecasts a 2026 contraction for the MENAP regional aggregate.

ENVIRONMENT Delhi adds metro services as Stage I smog controls take effect.

SECURITY The prime minister meets KP's apex security committee in Peshawar.

GULF SHIPPING Iran reports incidents near Hormuz amid further oil-market concern.

01 PAKISTAN

Governance, courts, security, external relations and the economy

SBP POLICY RATE	USD/PKR INTERBANK	KSE-100
11.50%	Rs 276.85	163,924.31
Latest cited decision; SBP Source	Close, 22 Oct 2026 Source	Close, 22 Oct 2026 Source

SECURITY | FEDERAL–PROVINCIAL RELATIONS

Prime Minister Chairs KP Security Apex Meeting

The Peshawar meeting puts coordination between federal and provincial institutions at the centre of the security debate.

On Thursday, 22 October, Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif chaired an apex committee meeting in Peshawar on Khyber Pakhtunkhwa's security challenges. Radio Pakistan reported the meeting at Governor House, placing the discussions within an already contentious debate over the relationship between the federal government and the province.

The federal authorities presented improved coordination as necessary for public safety and counterterrorism. Political disagreement remained acute in the wake of the imposition of governor's rule in the province earlier in October. Opposition figures associated with Pakistan Tehreek-e-Insaf opposed that measure and argued that representative provincial government should be restored.

The meeting itself was a security and administrative development; it did not settle the legal or political dispute over emergency governance. It also left open the practical question of how civilian institutions, policing and intelligence agencies will cooperate during a prolonged threat.

BACKGROUND

KP faces security challenges alongside constitutional questions about provincial autonomy. Earlier developments on governor's rule are context to the 22 October meeting, not separate events of the reporting day.

ANALYSIS / WHY IT MATTERS

Security policy gains legitimacy when authorities define responsibilities, ensure civilian oversight and explain results. Cooperative federalism and counterterrorism capacity are interdependent; neither question can be addressed through administrative orders alone.

THREE REVISION POINTS

1. The meeting took place on 22 October in Peshawar.
2. The venue reported by state media was Governor House.
3. Federal security coordination and provincial political authority were distinct issues.

CSS ANGLE Pakistan Affairs: internal security, federalism and public administration.

REPORTING [03] · [04]

ECONOMY | STATE-OWNED ENTERPRISES

Board Moves Ahead With Power-Utility Privatisations

Transaction approvals advance the sale process for distribution companies and reshape the state's role in commercial enterprises.

On Thursday, 22 October, the Privatisation Commission Board advanced transactions involving several state-owned enterprises. According to the Associated Press of Pakistan, it approved a list of ten prequalified bidders for Islamabad Electric Supply Company (IESCO) and took further decisions related to Faisalabad Electric Supply Company (FESCO).

The same meeting addressed transaction work for Zarai Taraqiati Bank Limited and preparatory arrangements concerning State Life Insurance Corporation. These steps form part of a wider programme to transfer commercial functions or ownership through specified procedures. A board approval or bidder shortlist, however, is not the same thing as a completed sale.

The significance of the decisions lies in the transaction sequence: eligibility screening, due diligence, valuation, regulatory and contractual terms, and final approval. Details of purchaser obligations, service standards and consumer protections determine whether ownership reform can deliver measurable outcomes.

BACKGROUND

Power distribution companies remain central to Pakistan's circular-debt and electricity-service problems. State-enterprise reform has been discussed repeatedly in connection with fiscal pressures and the need to improve efficiency.

ANALYSIS / WHY IT MATTERS

Privatisation should be judged by competitive bidding, transparent terms and post-sale regulation. Transferring ownership without addressing losses, governance and tariff design may simply relocate unresolved liabilities.

THREE REVISION POINTS

1. Ten bidders were prequalified for IESCO, according to APP.
2. ZTBL and State Life also featured in the board's agenda.
3. Prequalification is not completion of a privatisation transaction.

CSS ANGLE Current Affairs / Economy: SOE reform, competition and regulation.

REPORTING [05]

JUDICIARY | FUNDAMENTAL RIGHTS

LHC Seeks Answers on Detention of Khan's Sisters

The court summoned officials for a later hearing without deciding the underlying legality of detention.

On Thursday, 22 October, the Lahore High Court summoned Punjab's home secretary and the superintendent of Kot Lakhpat Jail in proceedings concerning the detention of three sisters of former prime minister Imran Khan. Dawn and The Express Tribune reported the order and a further hearing fixed for 28 October.

Counsel for Aleema Khan, Uzma Khan and Noreen Khan contended that detention had continued beyond the period permitted by the relevant orders. Petitioners referred to the lapse of earlier detention

orders around 19–20 October. These were arguments before the court, not judicial findings establishing unlawful custody.

The immediate judicial action was procedural: requiring relevant authorities to respond. The court had not, in the reported proceedings, finally resolved the validity of the detention. That distinction matters whenever allegations, interim orders and final judgments are reported in politically charged litigation.

BACKGROUND

Preventive detention sits at the intersection of public order powers, procedural requirements and constitutionally protected liberty. Courts generally examine the legal basis and duration of custody through the record placed before them.

ANALYSIS / WHY IT MATTERS

The case tests how promptly administrative authorities document detention grounds and how effectively judicial review can examine them. A defensible public-order framework must distinguish allegations of risk from proven legal authority to keep a person in custody.

THREE REVISION POINTS

1. The LHC summoned the Punjab home secretary and Kot Lakhpat Jail superintendent.
2. The petition concerned the detention of three sisters of Imran Khan.
3. The reported next hearing date was 28 October 2026.

CSS ANGLE Pakistan Affairs / Constitutional Law: preventive detention and judicial review.

REPORTING [06] · [07]

TRADE | PHARMACEUTICALS

Afghan Trade Disruption Hits Medicine Exports

New quarterly export figures intensify concern about the costs of interrupted regional commerce.

On Thursday, 22 October, export data reported by Dawn showed a decline in Pakistan's pharmaceutical sales abroad, with industry representatives linking a substantial part of the weakness to disruption of the Afghan trade route. Reported pharmaceutical exports for the first quarter of fiscal year 2026–27 stood at $73.301 million, down from $98.428 million in the corresponding previous-year period.

The reported decline was 25.53 per cent. For the preceding full fiscal year, the comparison cited in the report was $319.012 million against $457.456 million a year earlier. These numbers describe export values, not the quantity of medicines produced or a measured shortage in Afghan hospitals.

Industry representatives argued that restrictions and uncertainty affecting the Afghan market had limited orders and movement. Trade figures establish the downturn; the share attributable to any single border or policy decision requires more specific shipment-level evidence. Border closures also have implications for perishable products, transport employment and commercial trust.

BACKGROUND

Afghanistan has long been a nearby market for Pakistani producers. Regional trade depends on customs operations, transit arrangements, security rules and predictable border procedures.

ANALYSIS / WHY IT MATTERS

The immediate policy trade-off concerns security safeguards and export continuity. Digitised customs checks, risk-based inspections and predictable transit rules may reduce legitimate security risks without placing every shipment under indefinite uncertainty.

THREE REVISION POINTS

1. Q1 FY27 pharmaceutical exports were reported at $73.301 million.
2. The corresponding year-on-year fall was 25.53%.
3. The cited Q1 FY26 comparison was $98.428 million.

CSS ANGLE Current Affairs / Pakistan Affairs: regional trade, Afghanistan and industrial exports.

REPORTING [08]

DIPLOMACY | EUROPE

Zardari Begins Three-Day Visit to Germany

The president's visit draws attention to investment, economic links and the long-running bilateral relationship.

On Thursday, 22 October, President Asif Ali Zardari departed on an official three-day visit to Germany. The planned programme covered 22–24 October and included engagement with German leadership and business representatives, according to reports citing Pakistan's foreign office.

The visit came as Pakistan and Germany marked 75 years of diplomatic relations. It also created a diplomatic opening to discuss trade, investment and cooperation at a time when Pakistan seeks external capital and access to technologically advanced markets. Talks scheduled for a visit should not be represented as signed agreements before an official result is announced.

Germany's importance extends beyond bilateral commerce because it is a major European economy and an influential member of the European Union. Pakistan's European diplomacy must therefore be assessed in two layers: direct relations with Berlin and the implications for wider European trade and regulatory engagement.

BACKGROUND

Bilateral anniversaries offer an occasion for high-level diplomacy, but commercial relations depend on firm-level investment decisions and continuing regulatory compliance rather than ceremonial announcements.

ANALYSIS / WHY IT MATTERS

The measurable test will be follow-through: meetings that produce concrete investment projects, improved market access or sector-specific cooperation. Any claimed agreement requires confirmation after the visit, not inference from the itinerary.

THREE REVISION POINTS

1. The official visit was scheduled for 22–24 October 2026.
2. It was a three-day visit to Germany.
3. The visit coincided with 75 years of bilateral diplomatic relations.

CSS ANGLE Current Affairs / International Relations: Pakistan–Germany and Pakistan–EU relations.

REPORTING [09] · [10]

UNITED NATIONS | SCIENTIFIC COOPERATION

Pakistan Calls for Stronger UN Radiation Research Support

A UN committee intervention links scientific monitoring with stable institutional funding and risk communication.

On Thursday, 22 October, Pakistan urged sustainable resources for the United Nations Scientific Committee on the Effects of Atomic Radiation (UNSCEAR). Radio Pakistan reported that First Secretary Ansar Shah delivered the statement during discussion at the UN General Assembly's Fourth Committee.

The Pakistani representative said radiation-risk assessment depends on technical evidence, institutional expertise and predictable scientific support. He referred to work undertaken by the Pakistan Atomic Energy Commission and to international safety cooperation associated with the International Atomic Energy Agency.

UNSCEAR assesses scientific information about exposure to ionising radiation and its effects. Its role is distinct from the IAEA's broader remit in nuclear safeguards, safety and peaceful uses. Treating the institutions as interchangeable would obscure the precise subject of the UN intervention.

BACKGROUND

The UN General Assembly's Fourth Committee deals with special political and decolonisation matters, including certain scientific and peaceful-use questions. UNSCEAR's technical work informs wider regulatory debates without functioning as a national licensing authority.

ANALYSIS / WHY IT MATTERS

Independent evidence about exposure and health effects is essential for policy credibility. For countries using nuclear technology in energy, medicine and industry, sustained scientific assessment can improve protective standards and public trust.

THREE REVISION POINTS

1. Ansar Shah spoke for Pakistan, according to Radio Pakistan.
2. UNSCEAR studies the effects of atomic radiation.
3. The UN discussion took place in the Fourth Committee.

CSS ANGLE General Science / Current Affairs: UN bodies, radiation safety and scientific diplomacy.

REPORTING [11]

02 WORLD

Diplomacy, global economy, security and the environment

GLOBAL ECONOMY | IMF

IMF Sees MENAP Contraction Before Conditional Recovery

The projection applies to a regional aggregate and must not be mistaken for a forecast for Pakistan alone.

On Thursday, 22 October, the International Monetary Fund's regional outlook projected a 1.3 per cent contraction for the Middle East, North Africa and Pakistan region in 2026, followed by growth of 6.6 per cent in 2027. Reuters and other reports associated the forecast with the region's disrupted energy and trade environment.

The published figures refer to the IMF's MENAP grouping as a whole. They are not a forecast that Pakistan individually will contract by 1.3 per cent or grow by 6.6 per cent. This geographical qualification is essential because economic aggregates combine economies with very different exposure to oil production, shipping and domestic demand.

The rebound scenario depends partly on a restoration of more normal trade and energy flows. Its policy implications also vary by country. Energy exporters face interruptions to supply and revenue; import-dependent economies face higher bills, exchange-rate pressure and inflation transmission.

BACKGROUND

ANALYSIS / WHY IT MATTERS

IMF regional economic outlooks provide forecasts for defined country groupings. The same headline number can be misleading when treated as a national figure or detached from its stated assumptions.

Economic forecasts are conditional rather than promises. Analysts should identify the modelled region, baseline shocks and uncertainty range before using a projection to assess an individual government's policies.

THREE REVISION POINTS

1. The IMF's MENAP aggregate was forecast to contract by 1.3% in 2026.
2. The same aggregate was forecast to grow by 6.6% in 2027.
3. Neither percentage alone is a Pakistan-specific GDP forecast.

CSS ANGLE Current Affairs / International Relations: IMF forecasts and geopolitical economic shocks.

REPORTING [12] · [13]

MARITIME SECURITY | ENERGY

Iran Reports More Ship Incidents Near Hormuz

Unverified military claims and higher oil prices highlight the commercial risks around a crucial shipping corridor.

On Thursday, 22 October, Iran's Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps claimed that four vessels had been hit and caught fire in the Persian Gulf and that three other vessels had struck mines near the Strait of Hormuz. Reuters reported the Iranian statements. Independent confirmation of all the claimed incidents was not established in the account.

The reports coincided with concern in energy markets about the security of supply routes. The Guardian reported that Brent crude had touched approximately $112 a barrel amid threats to shipping and production. Price fluctuations are a market response to risk; they are not proof of the number of vessels hit or of responsibility for every reported incident.

The Strait of Hormuz connects the Gulf with the Gulf of Oman and the Arabian Sea. Even a limited disruption can increase insurance and freight costs, delay deliveries and complicate import financing. These mechanisms can affect countries that are not parties to the conflict.

BACKGROUND

Maritime security around Hormuz has long affected energy-market expectations. Earlier regional tensions provide context, while the new statements and pricing developments were reported on 22 October.

ANALYSIS / WHY IT MATTERS

The policy priority is distinguishing independently confirmed events from assertions by belligerents. Energy importers should assess exposure through shipping risk, inventories and the exchange-rate impact of higher import prices.

THREE REVISION POINTS

1. The IRGC claimed incidents involving four ships and three mine-struck vessels.
2. The individual claims were not independently verified in the cited report.
3. Brent was reported near $112 per barrel during the disruption.

CSS ANGLE International Relations / Current Affairs: chokepoints, maritime security and energy diplomacy.

REPORTING [14] · [15]

MIDDLE EAST | DIPLOMATIC REPRESENTATION

UN Expert Questions Indonesia's Gaza Board Role

A disagreement over Palestinian representation exposes the legitimacy challenges of externally designed peace structures.

On Thursday, 22 October, UN special rapporteur Francesca Albanese urged Indonesia to reconsider its involvement in a proposed Gaza Board of Peace, according to an interview reported by Reuters from Jakarta. She raised concerns about whether Palestinians would have a meaningful place in decisions affecting the territory.

The Reuters account said Indonesian officials had indicated that discussions over their country's involvement were on hold. Albanese's position is that of an independent UN-appointed expert, not automatically a collective ruling by the United Nations or the Security Council. The board's supporters and governments involved may contest her assessment.

The immediate issue concerns representation and accountability. Administrative or reconstruction mechanisms established without credible consultation risk facing political opposition even when their stated objectives include humanitarian relief. Durable legitimacy depends both on effective assistance and on the ability of affected communities to shape decisions.

BACKGROUND

Gaza's humanitarian and political future has involved competing international proposals. Disputes over mandate and membership are different from agreements on practical relief delivery.

ANALYSIS / WHY IT MATTERS

Diplomacy cannot rely only on the financial capacity of participating states. Representation, international law and clear institutional mandates affect whether an initiative is accepted by those it is supposed to serve.

THREE REVISION POINTS

1. Francesca Albanese made the remarks in Jakarta on 22 October.
2. She questioned Palestinian representation in the proposed arrangement.
3. The report said Indonesian membership discussions were on hold.

CSS ANGLE International Relations / Current Affairs: self-determination, multilateral legitimacy and Gaza.

REPORTING [16]

ENVIRONMENT | URBAN GOVERNANCE

Delhi Adds Metro Services as Pollution Controls Begin

The city's response shows the link between air-quality alerts, transport capacity and seasonal regulation.

On Thursday, 22 October, authorities in Delhi implemented or reinforced Stage I of the Graded Response Action Plan (GRAP) as the capital entered its annual period of elevated air-pollution risk. A report at 7 a.m. put the city's air-quality index at 226, in the category classified as poor.

Delhi Metro announced twenty additional weekday train trips beginning 22 October, according to Indian news reports. The measure sought to make public transport more convenient while emergency controls constrained polluting activity. An increase in scheduled services alone does not demonstrate that harmful particles have already fallen.

Winter conditions can trap pollutants near the surface, while vehicle exhaust, dust, industry and regional agricultural burning may contribute to hazardous air. Response frameworks depend on measured air-quality thresholds and a graduated set of restrictions. Their credibility rests on enforcement and the reliability of monitoring stations.

BACKGROUND

GRAP is a staged air-quality response system for Delhi and the surrounding National Capital Region. Activation responds to worsening measured or forecast air conditions.

ANALYSIS / WHY IT MATTERS

The lesson for large South Asian cities is to connect measurement, mobility and compliance. Emergency restrictions may reduce exposure in the short term, but year-round emissions management and regional cooperation determine lasting improvement.

THREE REVISION POINTS

1. Delhi's reported 7 a.m. AQI on 22 October was 226.
2. Delhi Metro added twenty weekday train trips.
3. Stage I GRAP measures were in force.

CSS ANGLE Environmental Science / Current Affairs: urban smog and environmental regulation.

REPORTING [17] · [18] · [19]

EUROPE | CONFLICT

Overnight Attacks Kill Civilians Across Ukraine

New reports of strikes and interceptions show how civilian infrastructure remains exposed despite diplomatic discussion.

On Thursday, 22 October, Ukrainian officials reported deaths and damage following overnight Russian missile and drone attacks. The Associated Press reported four people killed across twelve regions, including one in Kyiv, citing Ukrainian authorities. The figures were official wartime accounts and could change as assessments proceeded.

President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said the assault had included twenty-one ballistic missiles in three waves. Russia separately claimed to have intercepted 808 Ukrainian drones overnight. The Russian figure was a statement from its authorities, not an independently established total. The two sides' numbers describe different forms of attack and should not be combined as a single measure of the battle.

The latest strikes reinforced the immediate humanitarian question: warning time, shelter access, emergency medical response and the protection of homes and public services. A sustained exchange of long-range weapons also puts pressure on the finances and procurement systems of both sides.

BACKGROUND

The war has involved repeated long-range attacks on urban centres and energy networks. Discussions about possible further negotiations are background, not evidence that a ceasefire was in operation on 22 October.

ANALYSIS / WHY IT MATTERS

Diplomatic progress should be assessed against verified changes in violence and concrete agreements. During active conflict, competing military claims require attribution, independent corroboration and careful separation from civilian casualty reporting.

THREE REVISION POINTS

1. Ukrainian authorities reported four deaths across twelve regions.
2. Zelenskyy referred to twenty-one ballistic missiles in three waves.
3. Russia claimed 808 Ukrainian drones had been intercepted.

CSS ANGLE Current Affairs / International Relations: interstate war, humanitarian law and verification.

REPORTING [20]

Next Seven Days

23–24 OCT Germany visit: President Zardari's scheduled three-day official programme continues until 24 October. [9]

24–31 OCT UNESCO: Global Media and Information Literacy Week programme, with opening activity on 24 October. [29]

28 OCT Lahore High Court: reported next hearing in the detention petition concerning Imran Khan's sisters. [6]

03 GENERAL KNOWLEDGE

Evidence-based reference points from the previous reporting day

01 ECONOMY World Bank analysis reported Pakistan FY26 real GDP growth at 3.7%, versus 3.2% in FY25. [1]

02 FISCAL POLICY The FY26 primary fiscal surplus was reported as 2.9% of GDP. [2]

03 DEVELOPMENT The World Bank's per-capita income tripling scenario reaches to 2050 and is conditional on reform. [1]

04 DEVELOPMENT The modelled reform path required long-term growth around 6.2–6.9%. [2]

05 POWER Ten bidders were prequalified for Islamabad Electric Supply Company. [5]

06 BANKING Zarai Taraqiati Bank Ltd featured among transactions considered by the Privatisation Commission. [5]

07 JUDICIARY The LHC scheduled the next reported detention-petition hearing for 28 October 2026. [6]

08 TRADE Pharmaceutical exports in the first quarter of FY27 were reported at $73.301 million. [8]

09 TRADE The reported year-on-year Q1 FY27

11 UN SYSTEM UNSCEAR is the United Nations Scientific Committee on the Effects of Atomic Radiation. [11]

12 MULTILATERALISM Pakistan's UNSCEAR statement was delivered in the UN General Assembly Fourth Committee. [11]

13 GLOBAL ECONOMY IMF projected a 1.3% contraction in 2026 for MENAP as a region, not for Pakistan alone. [12]

14 GLOBAL ECONOMY IMF's 2027 growth projection for the MENAP aggregate was 6.6%. [13]

15 MARITIME The IRGC claimed four ships were hit and three others struck mines; the claims remained unverified. [14]

16 ENERGY Brent crude was reported around $112 per barrel during Gulf supply uncertainty. [15]

17 ENVIRONMENT Delhi's reported 7 a.m. air-quality index on 22 October was 226. [18]

18 TRANSPORT Delhi Metro announced twenty extra weekday train trips from 22 October. [19]

19 SECURITY Russia claimed interception of 808

pharmaceutical export decline was 25.53%. [8]

10 **DIPLOMACY** The president's official Germany visit was scheduled for 22–24 October 2026. [9]

Ukrainian drones overnight into 22 October. [20]

20 **PUBLIC LAW** The federal ombudsman institution of Pakistan was established by Presidential Order No. 1 of 1983. [27]

04 FIVE TERMS

Five enduring concepts across constitutional, diplomatic, economic, administrative and environmental studies

01 Bicameralism

A legislature with two chambers is bicameral. The two houses can represent populations and territorial units through different electoral rules.

WHY IT MATTERS It helps explain the relationship between representation and federal balance.

EXAMPLE Pakistan's Constitution provides for the National Assembly and the Senate in Parliament under Article 50.

Authoritative reference [24]

02 Non-refoulement

Non-refoulement is the principle that a person must not be returned to a place where specified serious threats to life or freedom arise. It is central to international refugee protection, with scope and exceptions requiring careful attention to applicable law.

WHY IT MATTERS It is a standard reference point in asylum, border management and human-rights analysis.

EXAMPLE Article 33 of the 1951 Refugee Convention contains the classic protection against return to persecution.

Authoritative reference [25]

03 Automatic Fiscal Stabilisers

Automatic fiscal stabilisers are tax and spending mechanisms that respond to economic conditions without a fresh legislative decision. Income-related tax receipts typically weaken in a downturn while eligible safety-net payments may rise.

WHY IT MATTERS They explain how budgets can cushion business cycles without immediate discretionary stimulus.

EXAMPLE During the 2007–09 financial crisis, built-in tax and benefit mechanisms helped soften changes in household disposable income.

Authoritative reference [26]

04 Ombudsman

An ombudsman is an independent complaints-review institution that examines maladministration by public bodies within a defined mandate. Its recommendations and procedures offer an administrative avenue of redress distinct from ordinary litigation.

WHY IT MATTERS The concept is important to accountable service delivery and accessible complaint resolution.

EXAMPLE Pakistan established the Office of Wafaqi Mohtasib on 24 January 1983 through a Presidential Order.

Authoritative reference [27]

05 Eutrophication

Eutrophication occurs when excessive nutrients, especially nitrogen and phosphorus, promote dense plant and algal growth in water. The subsequent ecological changes can deplete dissolved oxygen and harm aquatic life.

WHY IT MATTERS It links agriculture, wastewater regulation, environmental health and water governance.

EXAMPLE The US Environmental Protection Agency documents nutrient pollution as a cause of algal blooms and low-oxygen water bodies.

Authoritative reference [28]

05 PRACTICE

Fifteen multiple-choice questions based on the reports and reference concepts

Q01. What real GDP growth did the World Bank report for Pakistan in FY26?

A. 3.7%
B. 2.6%
C. 4.9%
D. 1.6%

Q02. The World Bank's conditional scenario concerns a possible tripling of income per person by which year?

A. 2030
B. 2050
C. 2040
D. 2065

Q03. How many bidders were prequalified for IESCO?

A. Six
B. Eight
C. Ten
D. Twelve

Q04. Where was the 22 October KP apex security committee meeting held?

A. Civil Secretariat
B. Assembly Secretariat
C. Peshawar High Court
D. Governor House

Q05. What date was given for the next LHC hearing concerning the detained sisters of Imran Khan?

A. 28 October
B. 24 October
C. 29 October
D. 3 November

Q06. What was the reported value of Pakistan's Q1 FY27 pharmaceutical exports?

A. $98.428m
B. $73.301m
C. $319.012m
D. $457.456m

Q07. Which of these was the SBP policy rate in the latest published decision cited here?

A. 10.0%
B. 12.5%
C. 11.5%
D. 9.5%

Q08. Which level is closest to the KSE-100 close on 22 October?

A. 160,224
B. 167,600
C. 158,800
D. 163,924

Q09. What was the IMF's reported 2026 growth forecast for the MENAP regional aggregate?

A. −1.3%
B. +1.3%
C. +3.7%
D. −6.6%

Q10. What was the IMF's reported 2027 growth outlook for MENAP?

A. 1.6%
B. 6.6%
C. 4.6%
D. 2.9%

Q11. Which UN special rapporteur questioned Indonesia's involvement in a proposed Gaza peace body?

A. Agnes Callamard
B. Mary Lawlor
C. Francesca Albanese
D. Catherine Russell

Q12. How many additional weekday metro trips were announced in Delhi?

A. 10
B. 15
C. 30
D. 20

Q13. What does UNSCEAR stand for?

A. United Nations Scientific Committee on the Effects of Atomic Radiation
B. United Nations Security Council Emergency Atomic Review
C. United Nations Strategic Commission for Energy and Radiation
D. United Nations Safety Committee for Environmental Assessment

Q14. Which article of the 1951 Refugee Convention contains the classic non-refoulement rule?

A. Article 20
B. Article 33
C. Article 51
D. Article 12

Q15. Which article of Pakistan's Constitution describes the composition of Parliament?

A. Article 58
B. Article 63
C. Article 50
D. Article 90

05 ANSWER KEY

Concise explanations and source references

01	**A**	The World Bank update gave FY26 growth as 3.7%. [1]
02	**B**	The long-term scenario ran to 2050, contingent on faster structural reform. [1]
03	**C**	APP reported approval of ten prequalified bidders. [5]
04	**D**	State media placed the meeting at Governor House in Peshawar. [3]
05	**A**	The report stated that the next hearing had been fixed for 28 October. [6]
06	**B**	Dawn cited a Q1 FY27 export value of $73.301 million. [8]
07	**C**	The SBP policy rate was 11.50% at the latest cited decision. [21]
08	**D**	The reported KSE-100 close was about 163,924. [23]
09	**A**	The regional forecast was a 1.3% contraction, not a Pakistan-only estimate. [12]
10	**B**	IMF projections put MENAP's 2027 growth at 6.6% subject to conditions. [13]
11	**C**	Reuters identified Francesca Albanese as the UN independent expert. [16]
12	**D**	Delhi Metro announced twenty additional weekday services. [19]
13	**A**	UNSCEAR is the UN Scientific Committee on the Effects of Atomic Radiation. [11]
14	**B**	Article 33 provides protection from refoulement subject to the Convention's terms. [25]
15	**C**	Article 50 refers to the President, National Assembly and Senate. [24]

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23 Pakistan Stock Exchange KSE-100 market close, 22 Oct 2026

24 Composition of Parliament, National Assembly of Pakistan

25 Non-refoulement and refugee protection, UNHCR

26 Automatic fiscal stabilisers, IMF research

27 Wafaqi Mohtasib establishment, federal ombudsman office

28 Nutrient pollution and eutrophication, United States EPA

29 UNESCO media and information literacy event, 24-31 Oct 2026, UN Indico

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